itself, was not much of a threat; the sting was in its tail. Hakim added that his wandering would not be directionless. It would take him to Turan.

Turan, along with Iran and Akbar's Hindustan, was one of three neighbouring and competing powers, each keeping a close eye for opportunities to expand its borders. Kabul – the kingdom, not just the city – was a critical buffer between Turan and Hindustan, and it would have been quite the coup for Turan's clever and ambitious Uzbek ruler, Abdullah, to give refuge to Kabul's exiled king and Akbar's estranged brother. Akbar couldn't risk it. He sent reassurances of his forgiveness to Hakim, who replied with fulsome apologies, professing 'his own want of wisdom . . . and his shame'.

The very next day, on 14 August, only a week after he had come, Akbar left Kabul so that Hakim might return to the city with whatever dignity remained to him. Arresting, or even executing his brother, as some in Akbar's court had advised, would have served no useful end; Hakim was crushed already.

So was any real remaining opposition to Akbar.

. Munis D. Faruqui, 'The Forgotten Prince: Mirza Hakim and the Formation of the Mughal Empire in India', *Journal of the Economic and Social History of the Orient*, vol. 48, no. 4, 2005.

. Lahore, after all, was held by Kamran in Kabul during Humayun's first stint on the Hindustani throne. Thus, as Faruqui argues, Punjab 'was a part of [Hakim's] patrimony that had been stolen following the untimely death of Humayun and the unequal partition of the Mughal Empire by Akbar's partisans'. Faruqui, 'The Forgotten Prince'.

. Edward Maclagan, *The Jesuits and the Great Mogul* (Burns Oates & Washbourne, 1932).

. Fr. Antonio Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate, S.J. on his Journey to the Court of Akbar*, trans. J.S. Hoyland, annotations S.N. Banerjee (Oxford University Press, 1922).

. It isn't clear if Pereira saw these paintings himself. It is improbable that Akbar invited the priest to dinner. More likely, the emperor told him about the art; thus Pereira could say to Monserrate that 'when naming them [Akbar] showed his true sentiments by putting Muhammad last' (Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*). This too may be a bit of wishful thinking by the priests – Akbar may have named him last because Muhammad was, in fact, the last prophet. More interesting is that Akbar had a painting of him hung on his walls, a heresy in Islam, without exciting any comment, it seems, from his critics – not even Badauni.

. Abdul Qadir Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh* (Selections from Histories), vol. 2, trans. W.H. Lowe (first published 1884–98; Atlantic Publishers and Distributors, 1990).

. Abu'l Fazl, *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl* (completed by Inayatullah), vol. 3, trans. Henry Beveridge (First published 1902–1939; Low Price Publications, 2017).

. Rudolf, a young Italian of noble birth who joined the Jesuits against his parents' wishes, was something of an absent-minded masochist, given to dressing in hair shirts, flogging himself, and misplacing his books and glasses. 'He burned with a great desire for a martyr's death,' writes Monserrate. 'For he often said, "Will these Musalmans never martyr us?" To which the other priest used to reply, "The King is too fond of us; no one dare touch us." At this Rudolf used to frown as if